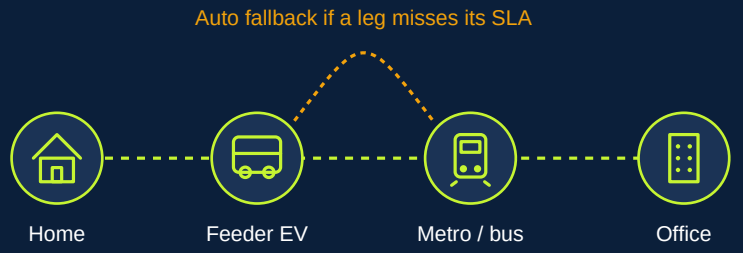
India doesn't need another vehicle. It needs a better commute.

The answer: We build **Ola Commute** for metro-city weekday commuters, a recurring, multimodal commute service that keeps mass transit as the backbone and **guarantees the missing first and last mile** with pooled electric feeders and a reliable fallback ride.



100M
daily users targeted by 2035, about 1 in 6 of 600M urban Indians

600M
urban residents expected in India by 2036

1,095 km
operational metro network in India, 2025

74.4%
congestion level in Bengaluru, 2025

The case in seven answers

1	Target user & problem	Metro-city weekday commuters living 3–8 km from transit; their pain is unreliable, high-friction connections between modes.	p.2
2	Why it matters in 2035	600M urban residents by 2036 and 1,095 km of metro are in place; NITI Aayog flags weak integration and recommends electric feeders.	p.2
3	Product & experience	One booking, one promise: Ola plans the full chain (pooled EV feeder, metro/bus, last mile) with an automatic auto fallback.	p.3
4	Alternatives & trade-offs	Five concepts and five commute modes scored; the multimodal commute layer ranks first (4.95 / 5).	p.4
5	Why Ola	MoveOS + OTA software, integrated EV manufacturing, retail/service/charging footprint and an established mobility brand.	p.4
6	Path to 100M (what must be true)	Density first: one corridor, then a city, then 60–80 cities, with 100M daily users by 2035.	p.5
7	Success metrics	North Star: weekly completed commutes per active rider, with explicit kill criteria after a 12-month pilot.	p.5

ASSUMPTIONS FOR 2035

This thesis holds only if:

- Urban populations continue to rise
- Metro and bus coverage expands
- EV operating costs decline
- Public transit remains the backbone
- Cities increasingly prioritize integrated, demand-responsive feeders

Sources: [1] World Bank, Financing India's Urban Infrastructure Needs (600M urban residents by 2036). [2] PIB/MoHUA, 2025 Metro Rail review (1,095 km, 26 cities). [3] TomTom Traffic Index 2025. [4] NITI Aayog, Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero: Transport. [6] MoHUA, PM-eBus Sewa.

The pain is the connection between modes, not a lack of transport

BEACHHEAD USER

Metro-city weekday commuter

- Predictable weekday travel pattern
- Lives 3–8 km from a mass-transit station
- Already willing to use shared transport
- Stitches together 2–3 modes every day
- Loses time and reliability at every switch

A typical daily chain

Walk → Auto → Metro → Walk

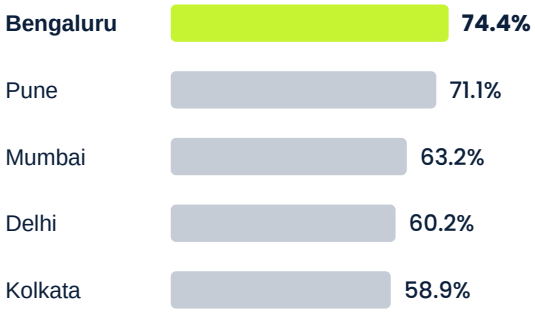
Segment size: [NEEDS SOURCE]

KEY INSIGHT

The core pain point is **not an absolute lack of transport**. It is the **friction, anxiety and unreliability** of the connections between modes.

Bengaluru leads congestion among major Indian cities, at 74.4%

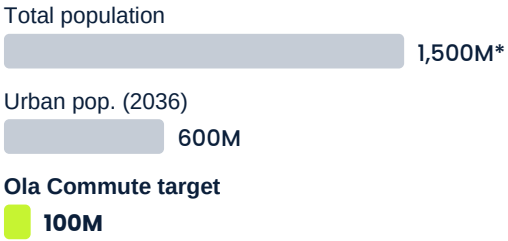
Average congestion level, %, 2025



Source: TomTom Traffic Index 2025 [3]

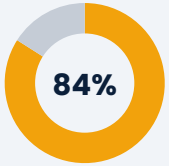
100M daily users is about 1 in 6 of India's 600M urban residents

Population, millions



Source: World Bank [1]. *Year/source needed [NEEDS SOURCE]

SAFETY IMPERATIVE



of work trips by women rely on public, intermediate or non-motorised transport

Chart: share of women's work trips, %. Source: World Bank [5]

Safety concerns and long waits restrict access to jobs and education. **Safety must be engineered as a core product requirement**, not run as a marketing campaign.

WHY NOW

600M urban residents projected by 2036

1,095 km metro network operational in 2025

NITI Aayog: poor service quality and inadequate integration remain major roadblocks; it recommends **electric feeders and shared mobility around mass transit**.

100M is a realistic denominator only because Ola Commute is a **layer over existing mobility**, not an owned fleet carrying 100M people.

Sources: [3] TomTom Traffic Index 2025 (congestion level by city). [1] World Bank, Financing India's Urban Infrastructure Needs. [2] PIB/MoHUA, 2025 Metro Rail review. [4] NITI Aayog, Transport scenarios. [5] World Bank, Designing Public Transport in India That Works for All. Total-population figure (1.5B): [NEEDS SOURCE: year and publisher].

Ola Commute: one booking, one promise, multiple modes

Set once
Home to office

→

Ola plans
Optimum chain

→

Feeder EV
First-mile pickup

→

Metro / bus
High-capacity backbone

→

Last mile
+ Auto fallback

Ola intelligence · Ola-controlled legs · City / operator infrastructure

Core user experience (illustrative screens)

STEP 1 · SET & FORGET

Ola Commute

Tomorrow · Home → Tech Park

Leave 8:20 AM

- Feeder pickup: 8:20
- Metro departs: 8:34

Confirm Commute

STEP 2 · ON THE WAY

Commute Promise

ON TIME

Arriving by 9:02 AM

Feeder (9/12 seats) **6 min away**

Metro (Blue Line) **On time**

View Live Track

STEP 3 · EXCEPTION

Fallback Ready

AUTO FALLBACK

Feeder delayed by 7 mins due to traffic.

Switching you to an Auto.

No extra charge.

Revised arrival: **9:05 AM**

Six features that deliver the promise

01 Recurring Commute
Save home and work once; Ola proposes the best departure time for every weekday.

02 Commute Promise
Optimizes end-to-end arrival reliability, favouring predictability over the cheapest single ride.

03 Shared EV Feeder
Pools 6–12 riders on high-density routes linking homes to transit stations.

04 One Fare
One pass covers feeder + transit (where API integration permits), removing search and payment friction.

05 Smart Fallback
If an Ola-controlled leg misses its SLA, the rider is upgraded to a direct auto/cab at a capped cost.

06 Safety Layer
Verified drivers, live trip sharing, pickup lighting guidelines and a frictionless SOS path.

STRATEGIC BOUNDARY

We deliberately do **not** build a new metro system, a robotaxi fleet or a nationwide bus operation. **Ola owns the customer promise, the routing logic and the orchestration;** cities and fleet partners own the heavy infrastructure.

Ola owns
Promise · Routing · Orchestration

Partners own
Heavy infrastructure · Fleet

Sources: [4] NITI Aayog, Transport scenarios (feeders and integrated shared mobility). App screens are illustrative concept mock-ups, not live product. "Where API integration permits": transit-operator integration is a dependency (see p.5).

The moat is coordination and density, not the vehicle itself

Five concepts scored: the multimodal commute layer ranks first

Score 1–5 per criterion; weight in brackets; weighted total out of 5

Concept	Problem (20%)	Frequency (15%)	Users (15%)	Ola edge (15%)	2035 fit (10%)	Scale (10%)	Econ. (10%)	Diff. (5%)	Total
Multimodal Commute	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	4	**4.95**
Dynamic mini-bus	5	5	5	4	5	4	4	4	**4.60**
Women-first mobility	5	4	3	4	5	4	3	4	**4.05**
Employer shuttles	4	5	2	4	5	3	3	3	**3.70**
Autonomous pods	4	3	3	4	2	2	2	5	**3.15**

5 4 3 1–2 (weak spot)

Against today's commute modes, only Ola Commute pairs transit economics with reliability

Cost: $ low to $$$ high. Dots: 1–5, 5 is best

Mode	Cost	Reliability	Flexibility	Scale	Why it wins or loses
Own bike	$$	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●○○○	Fast, but adds ownership cost, parking friction and congestion.
Cab / Auto	$$$	●●●○○	●●●●●	●●●○○	Flexible, but prohibitively expensive for daily commuting.
Metro + Auto	$	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●●●	Cheap backbone, but transfer friction and waits stay high.
Fixed bus	$	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●●●●	Great economics, but weak flexibility for fragmented suburban demand.
Ola Commute	$$	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●●	Mass-transit efficiency, plus it solves the critical connection problem.

KEY INSIGHT

The hardest part is **not building the AI**. It is getting enough people on the same corridors at the same time, and earning the right to coordinate with cities and operators. **If Ola solves that, the vehicle becomes a commodity and the commute promise becomes the product.**

Why Ola: four assets, one mobility layer

Ola Electric today → what it becomes

MoveOS + OTA software capability

IN 2035

A mobility layer that continuously optimizes routes, charging, vehicle health and rider experience.

Integrated EV manufacturing & supply chain

IN 2035

Standardized feeder vehicles with lower operating costs and highly predictable service uptime.

Large retail, service & charging footprint

IN 2035

The physical operating backbone for rapid city launches, fleet maintenance and partner support.

Existing mobility brand & consumer behavior

IN 2035

Much lower friction to introduce a daily-use mobility habit than a new market entrant.

Sources: [7] Ola Electric, MoveOS 5 announcement. [8] Ola Electric business / DRHP materials. [9] Ola Electric investor relations (retail, service and charging footprint). Scores: author's assessment, weighted per header (scale 1–5); weighted totals recalculated from the weights shown.

Density first: win one corridor, then a city, then 60–80 cities

MVP roadmap: prove the habit before scaling

0–3 MONTHS
1 corridor
- 500–1,000 riders
- Manual ops
- 3–5 feeder routes

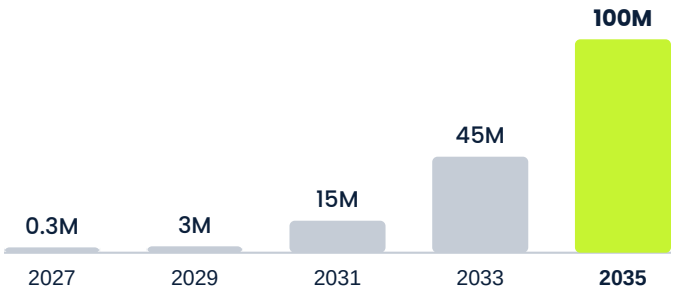
3–6 MONTHS
3 corridors
- Recurring bookings live
- Initial transit / operator API integration

6–12 MONTHS
1 city
- 10k+ active riders
- Commute Promise + automated fallback

12–24 MONTHS
3 cities
- 100k+ active riders
- Expand only after unit economics proven

Scale is back-loaded: 45M daily users in 2033 must become 100M by 2035

Ola Commute daily users, millions (target path)



Expansion order

1. Bengaluru
2. Delhi NCR
3. Mumbai
4. Pune / Hyderabad
5. Chennai / Ahmedabad
6. **Next 40–60 cities**

Launch one dense corridor, then a full city; later cities need transit density and operator supply.

100M math 100M daily users, not 100M owned vehicles, spread across **60–80 cities**: at 60 cities that averages **1.67M daily users per city**.

Growth engine: density flywheel

More commuters → Higher feeder utilization → Lower cost, better frequency → More commuters

Illustrative target economics per completed commute (currency unit to confirm)

Direct mobility + operator cost: 31	Contribution: 9	Revenue 40

WHAT MUST BE TRUE

Enough riders share the same corridors at the same time
Risk: Empty seats destroy pooled-vehicle economics.
How: Launch corridor by corridor; require pre-booking by recurring commuters before adding vehicles.

Cities and operators open data, fares and pickup access
Risk: Without them the “one product” illusion breaks.
How: Start with one progressive transit agency; open APIs / contracts; keep fallback under tight Ola control.

The commute promise holds
Risk: A missed transfer destroys trust faster than a cab delay.
How: Guarantee only Ola-controlled legs at first; cap fallback exposure.

Unit economics work at scale
Risk: Target: 9 contribution on 40 revenue per commute.
How: Drivers: vehicle utilization, routing efficiency, procurement scale, repeat rate.

Success metrics and kill criteria

NORTH STAR
Weekly completed commutes per active rider
Tests whether Ola is a daily habit, not an occasional fallback ride.

- 30-day cohort repeat rate — **≥ 35% floor**
- Feeder capacity utilization — **≥ 55% floor**
- On-time arrival % — *[NEEDS SOURCE] target*
- Fallback trigger rate — *[NEEDS SOURCE] target*
- Contribution / commute — **9 of 40 target**

KILL / PIVOT: after 12 months in 3 pilot cities, if repeat usage is below 35% **and** feeder utilization below 55% despite adequate corridor density, halt expansion and redesign the operating model.

All sources: [1] World Bank, Financing India’s Urban Infrastructure Needs · [2] PIB/MoHUA, Metro Rail review 2025 · [3] TomTom Traffic Index 2025 · [4] NITI Aayog, Transport scenarios · [5] World Bank, Designing Public Transport in India · [6] MoHUA, PM-eBus Sewa · [7] Ola Electric, MoveOS 5 · [8] Ola Electric, DRHP · [9] Ola Electric investor relations. Growth path and economics are illustrative target-state figures from the case; currency unit of the economics: [NEEDS SOURCE].